# Iron Maiden Adds One Last North American Tour Leg for 2027

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Heavy metal band Iron Maiden will return to North America in 2027 for the third and final **leg** of its Run for Your Lives tour. The tour celebrates the band's 50th **anniversary**.

The band announced the new dates on Friday, October 16. Iron Maiden had planned to take a break from live shows in 2027. But **bassist** Steve Harris said the band has been enjoying its current shows in the United States and Canada so much that they changed their plans.

"We all had a chat and decided we should take the show to parts we missed, particularly the North West and South East," Harris said. He said it seemed fair to fans there who have supported the band for many years.

The tour will begin April 14, 2027, at the Tacoma Dome in Tacoma, Washington. It will end May 11 at UBS Arena in Belmont Park, New York. Other stops include Vancouver, Portland, Phoenix, Dallas, Tampa, Atlanta, Raleigh and Hartford.

Two other British bands, Bullet For My Valentine and The Raven Age, will join as **special guests**. It will be the first time since 1983 that Iron Maiden has toured with two other British bands.

After the tour, the band will play two US music **festivals**: Sonic Temple in Columbus, Ohio, on May 14, and Boardwalk Rock in Ocean City, Maryland, on May 16. "At **festivals** you are not just playing to your own fans so it's always a challenge and we all love a challenge!" Harris said.

By the end, the Run for Your Lives tour will have played 107 shows. A **press release** said these dates "will definitely be the last" of the tour. Iron Maiden is in the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame.

## Word Treasure

**leg** -- One part of a long tour, usually covering one region.

**anniversary** -- A date that marks how many years have passed since something began.

**bassist** -- A musician who plays the bass guitar.

**special guests** -- Other performers invited to play at a show alongside the main act.

**festivals** -- Big events where many bands perform for crowds.

**press release** -- An official announcement sent to news reporters.

## Background you need

Iron Maiden is a British heavy metal band that has played around the world for decades.

Big bands often split long tours into parts called legs, each covering a different region.

Special guests play at the same shows as the main band, often performing first to warm up the crowd.

Music festivals bring many bands together in one place, so performers play for fans of other groups too.

## Break it down

**LEAD:** Iron Maiden adds a final North American leg to its Run for Your Lives tour in 2027
**KEY EVENT:** New dates announced Friday, October 16, replacing a planned 2027 break
+- WHY: Bassist Steve Harris says they want to reach the North West and South East
+- WHEN/WHERE: April 14 in Tacoma, Washington, to May 11 in Belmont Park, New York
+- GUESTS: Bullet For My Valentine and The Raven Age
**EXTRA:** Two US festivals, Sonic Temple on May 14 and Boardwalk Rock on May 16
**DETAIL:** The tour will total 107 shows, and these dates will be the last

## Why it matters

It shows how long-lasting bands keep connecting with fans and plan tours around the places where those fans live.

## Test what you remember

**1. What does the Run for Your Lives tour celebrate?**

- (A) The band's first concert
- (B) A movie release
- (C) The band's 50th anniversary
- (D) A new album

**2. When did Iron Maiden announce the new dates?**

- (A) Saturday, October 17
- (B) May 11
- (C) April 14
- (D) Friday, October 16

**3. Where will the 2027 tour begin?**

- (A) The Tacoma Dome in Tacoma, Washington
- (B) Vancouver, Canada
- (C) Atlanta, Georgia
- (D) UBS Arena in New York

**4. Which bands will join as special guests?**

- (A) Bullet For My Valentine and The Raven Age
- (B) The Tacoma Dome and UBS Arena
- (C) Run for Your Lives and Belmont Park
- (D) Sonic Temple and Boardwalk Rock

**5. Why did the band decide to add these dates?**

- (A) Because it lost a contest
- (B) Because tickets were cheap
- (C) To reach parts it missed, especially the North West and South East
- (D) To record a new album

**6. How many shows will the whole tour have played by the end?**

- (A) 14
- (B) 50
- (C) 1983
- (D) 107

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: A 4: A 5: C 6: D

## Questions to think about

**1. Steve Harris, Iron Maiden bassist: Says it seemed fair to play for fans in places the band missed and that the band loves the challenge of festivals.**

### MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):